ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

THA 151: Speech and Communication for Stage and Media

Voice work, articulation and delivery that survive a microphone and a hall

THEATRE & FILM

Theatre & Film Studies

Faculty of Arts
Theatre & Film Studies | 100L

OUTLINE ARCHIVE: 2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

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Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Your voice is an instrument that must be maintained and trained. This pack covers breathing and support, resonance, articulation, projection without strain, microphone technique, and the differences between stage delivery and broadcast delivery.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Support the voice with diaphragmatic breathing rather than throat tension.
- Identify and correct common Nigerian English articulation issues without shame.
- Project in a large hall without damaging the voice.
- Adapt delivery for radio, television and recorded voice-over.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Breath, support and resonance

Volume comes from breath support and resonance, not from shouting.

- Breathe low into the abdomen; shoulders should not rise.
- Control exhalation steadily to sustain a line to its end.
- Resonance chambers: chest, mouth and nasal cavities shape timbre.
- Warm up with humming, lip trills and gentle scales.
- Hydrate; avoid shouting over noise as a habit.
- Stop and rest if you feel pain or persistent hoarseness.

Articulation and accent

Intelligibility is the goal; erasing your accent is not.

- Work on final consonants, consonant clusters and word endings.
- Distinguish minimal pairs that affect meaning in your context.
- Mark stress in multisyllabic words and avoid misplaced stress.
- Pace and pausing carry meaning as much as pronunciation.
- Use tongue twisters for agility, not as a performance in themselves.
- Record yourself weekly and compare against a specific target, not a vague ideal.

> **Stage versus microphone**
> On stage you project to the back row; at a microphone you work close and controlled. Practise both, because the habits are different.

Delivery for stage and broadcast

The medium changes the technique.

- Stage: project, articulate for distance, sustain energy through long speeches.
- Radio: paint pictures with voice alone; pace and pause do the work of visual expression.
- Television: controlled energy, natural eyeline, awareness of framing.
- Voice-over: precise timing to picture, consistent tone, clean breaths.
- Interview or news reading: neutral warmth, accurate pronunciation of names.
- Always test the microphone and monitor before a recording.

OUTLINE ARCHIVE

Session record: THA 151

2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Year demarcation matters: a course code that existed in 2018 may have been renumbered, merged or dropped by 2019, and the department now also runs a film track. Read the year label before you rely on a code. The current entry below is a compiled map - take it to your course rep or the departmental office and confirm it before registration.

2018 — Archived course description — ARCHIVED

- THA 151 Basic Speech and Communication for Stage and the Media
- Vocal mechanism, range, interpretive devices and voice training for the actor, public speaker, newscaster or radio presenter
- Voice integrated with body as actors hold the stage

Source: unizik.edu.ng - Theatre & Film Studies course description (page dated 31 May 2018; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

2019 — Archived programme listing — ARCHIVED

- THA 151 Basic Speech and Communication for Stage and the Media, 3 credits
- New THA 153 Communication Models in Theatre and Media appears in the same semester
- Later media courses build on this: THA 252 and THA 324

What changed: The 2019 listing adds THA 153 as a separate communication-theory course beside the practical voice course.

Source: arts.unizik.edu.ng - Theatre Arts programme and course map (page dated 18 Oct 2019; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

2025/2026 — Compiled working map — CURRENT WORKING MAP

- Speech and communication remains a 100-level core in the compiled map
- Broadcast and voice-over assessment is likely, given the department film track
- Confirm whether THA 153 is still taught alongside it

Source: Compiled by ZikShare from the archived 2018 and 2019 departmental pages plus the published stress areas; this is a working map, not an official handout (retrieved 2026-10-22)

Archive means: this records what a public departmental page listed in that year. It is not a guarantee of the current curriculum, and ZikShare is not affiliated with UNIZIK.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. How do you know you are breathing with support?

Answer: The abdomen and lower ribs expand while the shoulders stay relatively still, and you can sustain a controlled exhalation.

2. Why is shouting a bad projection strategy?

Answer: It strains the vocal folds and produces a harsh sound that does not carry as well as supported resonance.

3. Give two differences between stage and microphone delivery.

Answer: Stage delivery requires projection to the back of the hall; microphone delivery uses close, controlled volume and greater attention to plosives.

4. What should you mark on a script before a reading?

Answer: Breaths, pauses, stressed words and any difficult names or sounds.

5. Why record yourself?

Answer: Recording exposes habits you cannot hear in the moment and allows measurable improvement against a target.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Practise diaphragmatic breathing for five minutes daily for a week.
- [ ] Warm up the voice before every studio or rehearsal session.
- [ ] Record and review a two-minute reading.
- [ ] Mark stress and pauses on one script extract.
- [ ] Practise a broadcast-style read at the microphone.
- [ ] Read a passage aloud in a large hall and check the back row can hear.
- [ ] Ask a tutor for one specific correction and apply it for a week.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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